And invariably, as history records, successive governments have appreciated the wisdom of the Reserve Bank's counsel.

No institution is bigger than the people who work for it. If the Reserve Bank is respected today, it is because of the many thousands who have worked over the years for the Bank, with capability and dedication. Let me recognize two as representative of the many. Rani Durve, a DGM in the Bhopal office, has created numerous films, books, and street plays on themes such as fictitious emails and excessive interest rates so as to educate and alert the public. Nirmal Pattnayak, an AGM in the Department of Information Technology, enabled the pan-India electronic transfer of funds for government departments through the national electronic payment systems, thus overnight making the government a significant user of these systems. Both have gone beyond the ordinary call of duty, but so do many others in the Bank.

Equally commendable is the general integrity of the staff. It is a matter of great pride for me today that when someone enters our building to persuade us to change a regulation, they come armed not with money but with arguments about what is right.

Strong national institutions are difficult to build. Therefore existing ones should be nurtured from the outside, and constantly rejuvenated from the inside, for there are precious few of them. Rejuvenation means constantly thinking about how we can do better in serving the people of this country. Whether we contribute by speeding up files we are sitting on, curtailing expenses, simplifying paperwork and regulations, doing innovative research, or working cooperatively with colleagues, there are many ways we all can do our bit. I ask you to join me in rededicating ourselves in the 81st year of this great institution to ensure that the Reserve Bank of India continues to help the nation secure prosperity and economic opportunity for all.